[LOGO AREA]

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CYBERSECURITY | VAPT

SECURITY ASSESSMENT REPORT

TryHackMe – Search Skills

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Overview

This room focuses on finding useful information online and knowing which sources to use. In cybersecurity you need to find the right documentation, identify a service, or research a vulnerability before deciding what to do next.

1. Shodan

Shodan is a search engine that collects information about internet-connected devices and services. Unlike a normal search engine, it can help identify exposed services, open ports, and information about the software running on a host.

This is useful during reconnaissance because service information can help identify technologies that may need further investigation.

One important thing to remember is that finding an exposed service doesn't automatically mean it is vulnerable. The information needs to be verified and assessed in context.

2. VirusTotal

VirusTotal lets you investigate files, URLs, domains, and file hashes using information from multiple security vendors and analysis tools.

A file hash is particularly useful when you want to investigate a file without relying on its filename. Searching for a hash can reveal whether security vendors have flagged the file and provide additional information about it.

However, a detection result isn't definitive proof that a file is malicious, and a lack of detections doesn't guarantee that it is safe.

3. Vulnerability Research

When investigating a vulnerability, it's important to identify the affected software and understand the potential impact.

CVE identifiers provide a common reference for publicly disclosed vulnerabilities. Vulnerability databases can provide details about affected products, severity ratings, and other relevant information.

Proof-of-concept code may also be available on platforms such as GitHub. Finding a PoC is only the beginning; you still need to understand what it does, check whether it applies to the target version, and verify that the source is trustworthy.

4. Technical Documentation

Documentation is one of the most useful resources when learning cybersecurity tools.

On Linux, manual pages provide information about commands, their options, and examples of how to use them. For example:

```
man nc
```

This opens the manual page for Netcat, a utility commonly used for network connections and troubleshooting.

Instead of memorising every option, it is more useful to know how to find the relevant information when you need it.

5. GitHub

GitHub is useful for researching security tools, vulnerability analyses, and proof-of-concept code. Searching for a CVE identifier can help locate repositories related to a particular vulnerability.

However, code published on GitHub should not automatically be trusted. Before running a script, read the source code, understand what it does, and check whether it comes from a credible source.

Conclusion

The main lesson from this room is that knowing where to look for information is an important part of cybersecurity. Whether I'm investigating a service, researching a vulnerability, or trying to understand a command, I need to find reliable information and verify it before drawing conclusions.

These are skills I'll continue using as I work through networking, enumeration, and web application security labs.

